



Laptop import restrictions explained

Do you need to worry about your next purchase?

Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in

In a move that sent shockwaves across the consumer electronics market in India, the Government of India's Ministry of Commerce and Industry has announced a new set of rules restricting the import of laptops, tablets, AIOs, ultra-small form factor computers, and servers.

The notice issued by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade lists out all the changes made to the import directives

of the above-mentioned consumer electronics goods in the country. This move has come right before the start of the festival season in the country, which sees record sales of laptops and tablets.

What does the laptop import ban exactly mean?

The news has brought along several doubts and questions in the minds of consumers looking to get their hands on one of the now-restricted devices. So, here's a detailed look at what the new regulations mean and how they could affect your next purchase –

The import of laptops, tablets, AIOs, ultra-small form factor computers, and servers is not banned in India altogether. Now, the entities willing to import these devices will now need a special license. These devices have been moved from being listed under the "Free" category of imported goods to "Restricted".

If you are someone who was looking to import a laptop from abroad as a part of a purchase on an e-commerce portal or via personal channels, then you are still free to do that. As stated in the notice, the import restrictions do not apply to the import of "1 Laptop, Tablet, All-in-one Personal Computer, or Ultra small form factor Computer, including those purchased from e-commerce portals, through post or courier." However, you will still have to pay the applicable import duty fees.

Lastly, if you are someone who is involved in the research and development/testing/benchmarking and evaluation/repair of the products that are all under the new regulations, then you are in luck! Given that you are able to provide proof of the fact that the